

8 EMAIL TEMPLATES TO UPGRADE YOUR RECURRING DONORS



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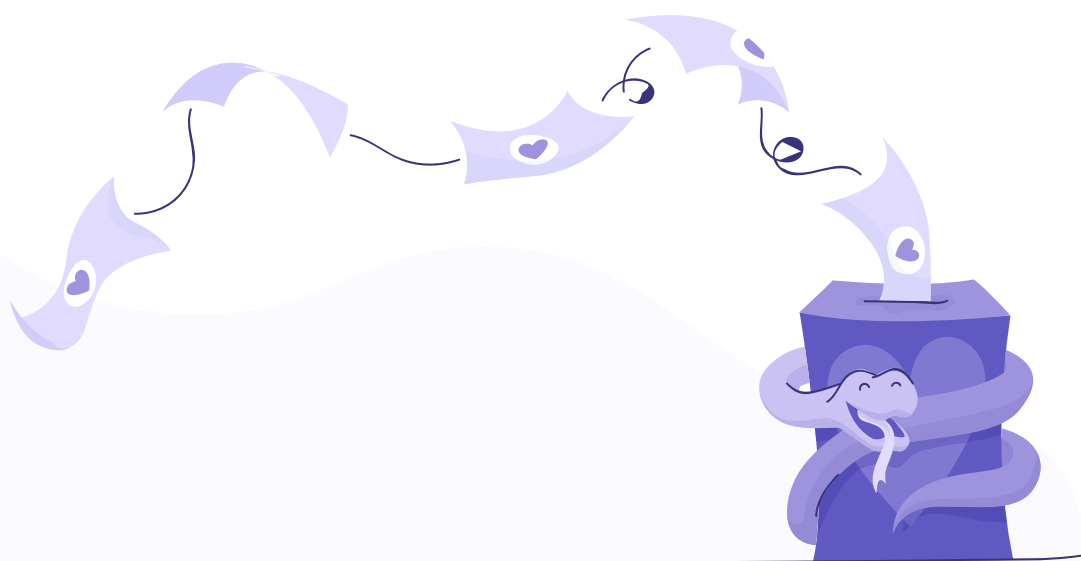
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Introduction

Recurring donors are over five times more valuable than one-time donors.¹ Not only do these dedicated supporters commit to monthly gifts that provide a predictable stream of revenue, but they also give additional one-time gifts on top of their commitments.

In fact, recurring donors make additional one-time gifts on top of their recurring subscription 75% more often than one-time donors do. Recurring donations don't reduce the size of these one-time gifts either. The average one-time donation size is actually higher for donors with recurring giving plans at \$150, versus \$113.

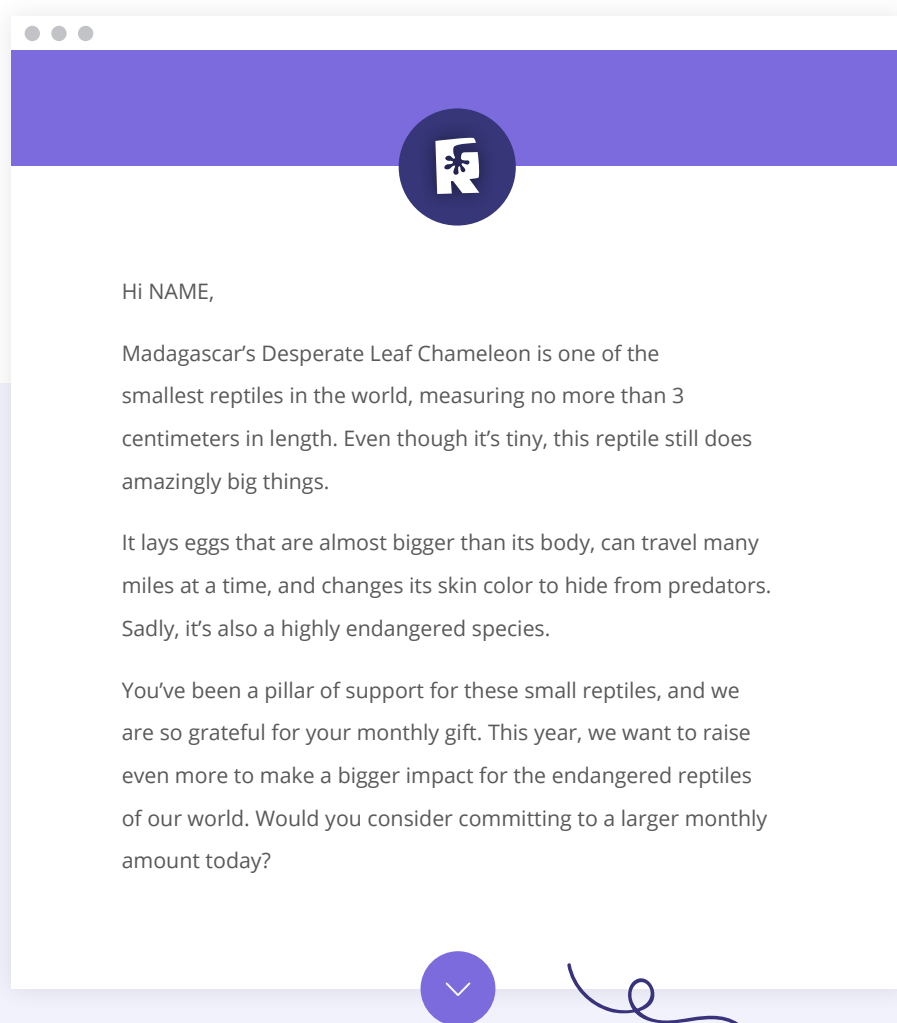
There's an opportunity to upgrade your recurring donors to give higher monthly amounts, add an additional one-time gift on top of their monthly donation, or both. We created eight email templates to help inspire your creativity and inform your asks.



¹ Classy, "The State of Modern Philanthropy: Examining Online Fundraising Trends." <https://go.classy.org/reports/the-state-of-modern-philanthropy>

1 | Impact Appeal

At some point during the year, reach out to your recurring donors to not only thank them for their support, but also showcase how their impact can increase with a higher gift amount. Articulate how exactly that higher gift amount would make a difference on your programs, the major issues you tackle, and the advancement of your mission.



KEEP
READING ↓



Here's how different gift amounts can make a difference:



\$50 per month

Bring our reptile education roadshow to two new schools per year



\$100 per month

Fund the cost of a trip for one researcher to study in the field



\$150 per month

Power our conservation programs to save at least two chameleons from extinction per year

[Increase My Impact](#)



We appreciate your commitment, and so does the Desperate Leaf Chameleon!

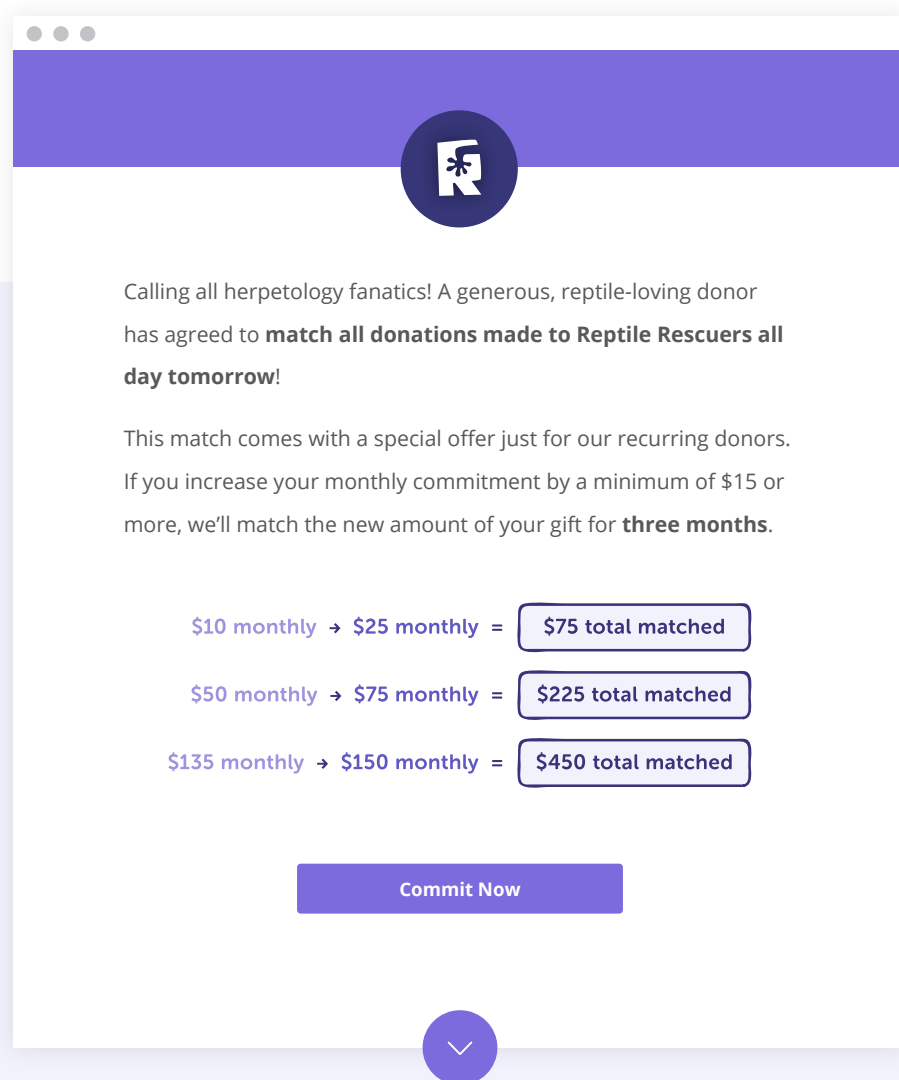
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2 | Matching Gifts

Consider how you can leverage a matching gift period to motivate recurring donors to stretch their impact even further.

Reach out to your existing recurring donors to announce the matching gift and encourage them to either increase their monthly gift or make a one-time donation. In the email, clearly define the terms of the match, how their upgraded gift helps, and finish with a strong ask.





We'll also match any of our recurring donors who make a one-time gift on top of their monthly commitment:

\$10 monthly → \$5 one-time = **\$10 total matched**

\$10 monthly → \$20 one-time = **\$40 total matched**

\$10 monthly → \$50 one-time = **\$100 total matched**

The more you give, the more we match.

Our scaly friends couldn't be more excited for your support!

[Donate Now](#)

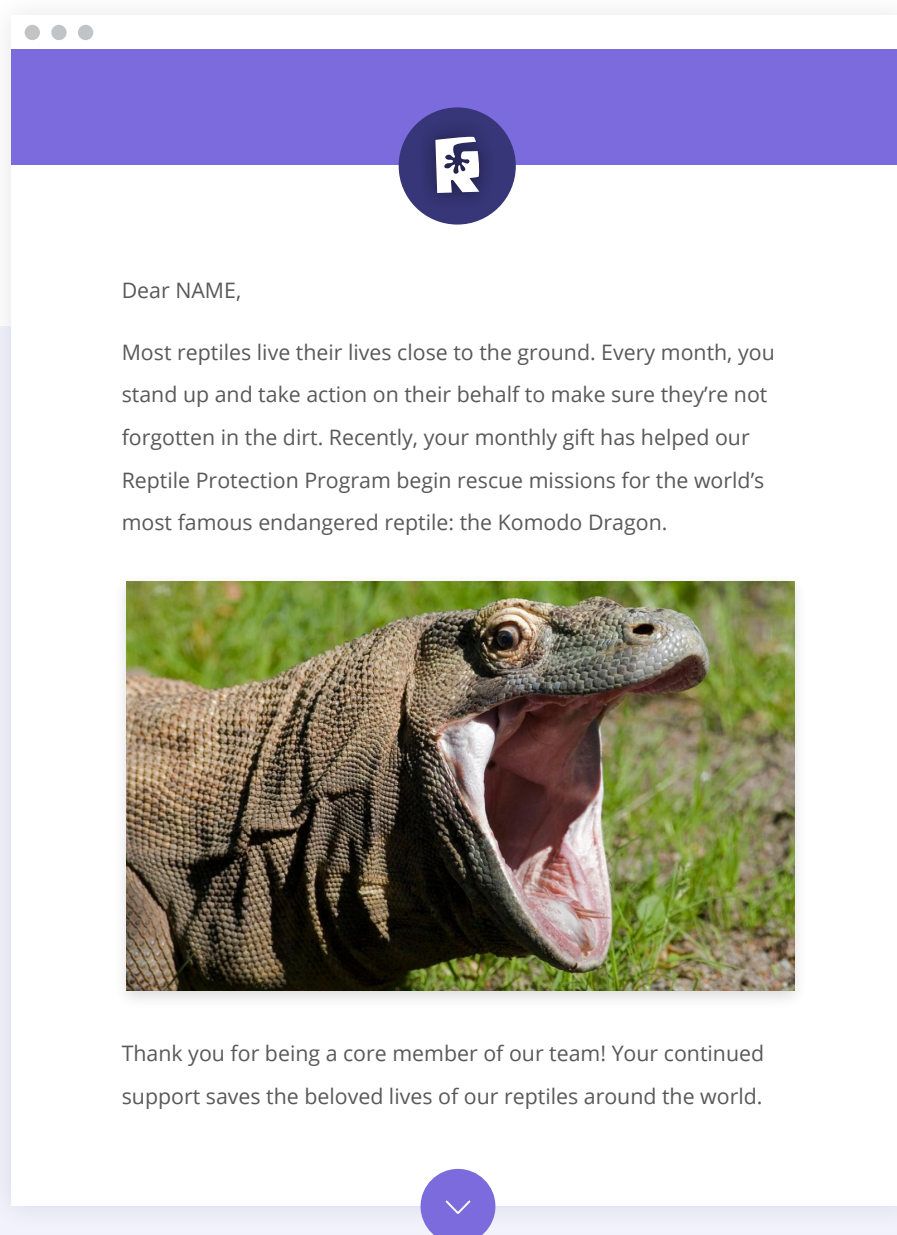


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3 | Thank You Note

Find a special opportunity to thank your donors, and use that touchpoint to ask them to consider upgrading their gift. Maybe you send an email on the anniversary of their gift, or the moment you fund a major program with the help of their support. Regardless, the thank-you email serves as a reminder for why they got involved in the first place. As such, it's a natural opportunity to ask them to recommit at a higher monthly amount.





In the next year, we plan to expand our protection services to other high-risk reptiles. We know this is an ambitious goal, and we're looking to our dedicated community to help us make this possible. Would you consider committing to a higher monthly gift today? Through your generosity, we'll be able to kickstart this growth with a bang.

[I Want to Save More Reptiles](#)

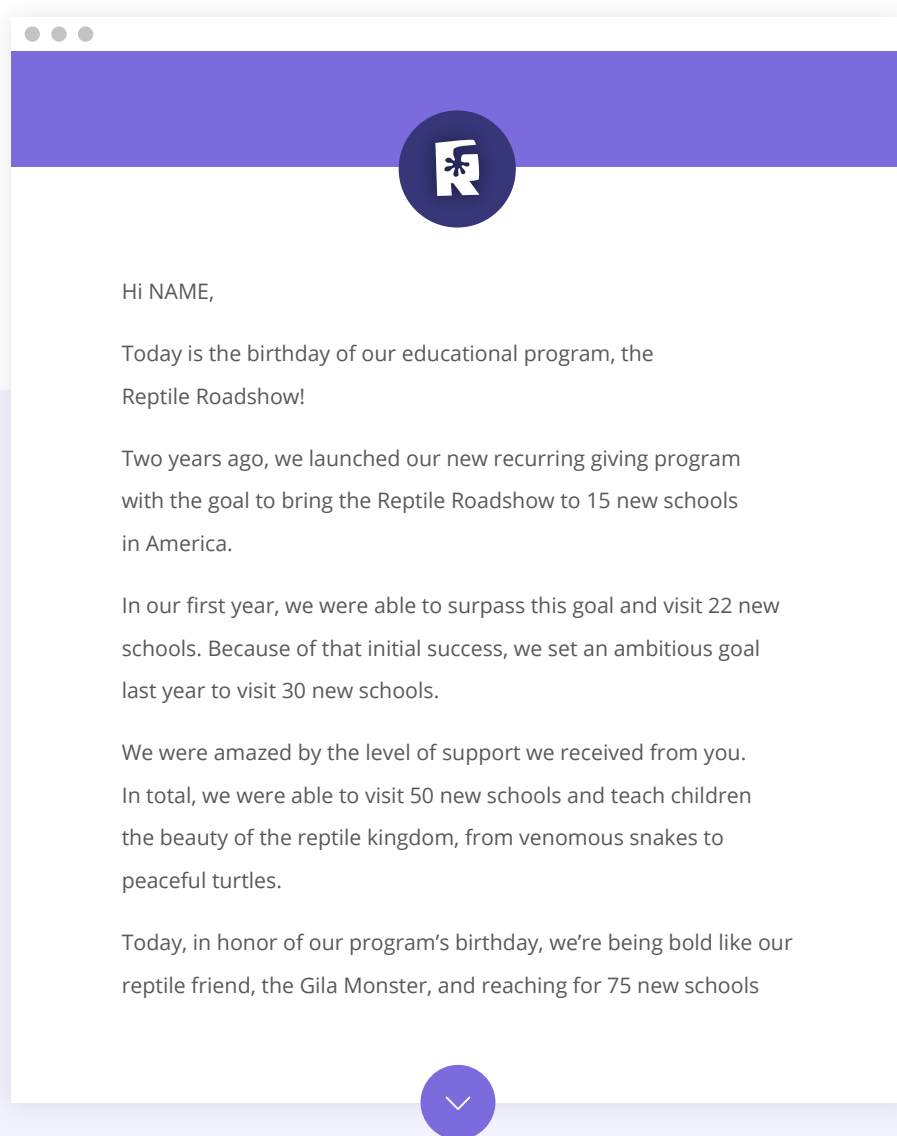
We're proud to have you on our side, standing up for the lives of endangered reptiles all over the world. Together, we can win this fight!

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4 | Milestone Days

Any big milestone, like your nonprofit's birthday, a major event, or the anniversary of your flagship program, are cause for celebration. Use these touchpoints to reach out to your recurring donors and provide them with impact statistics on your progress. Follow up with a strong call to action asking them to upgrade their gift.





this year! Help us achieve our goal by committing to a higher monthly gift today.

[Bump Up My Gift](#)

Thank you so much for your support. We couldn't be prouder to call you a partner in this work, and we look forward to seeing what else we can accomplish together.



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5 | Cause Awareness Days

Cause awareness days are an organic opportunity to reach out to your recurring donors. For example, you might run a crowdfunding campaign around the day and send an email that asks recurring donors to donate a one-time gift. You could even offer an exclusive incentive just for recurring donors who upgrade their commitment.





Madagascar Leaf-Nosed Snake

The way this snake's body has evolved allows it to blend in almost perfectly with surrounding vines as it stalks prey. Sneaky!



Gharial

A prehistoric animal, this Crocodilian is a pro at catching incredibly fast fish in its freshwater habitat. Impressive!

To celebrate, our "Reptile Day Revelry" campaign aims to raise \$20,000 for reptile conservation, and we'd love the continued support of our dedicated monthly supporters. Donate today to help us reach our goal!

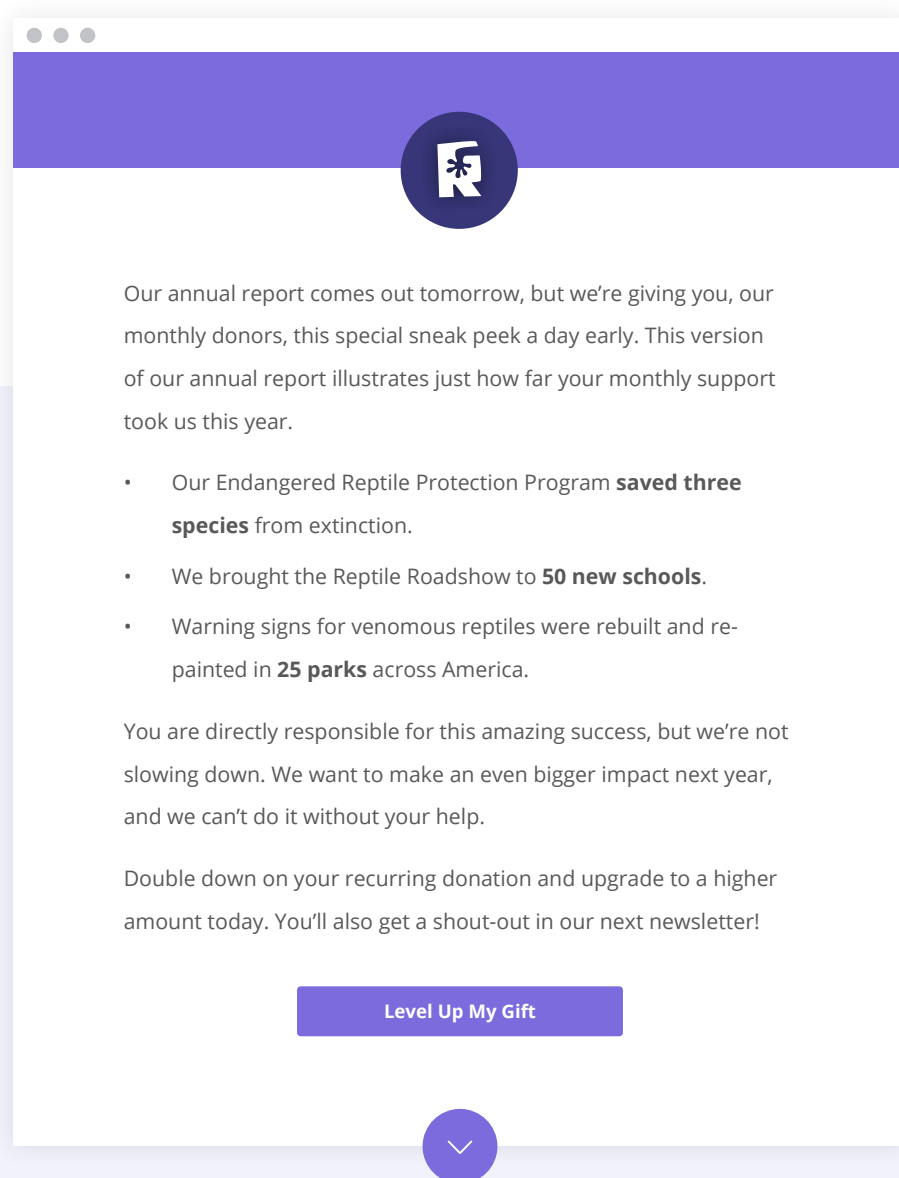
[Donate Now](#)

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6 | Annual Report Announcement

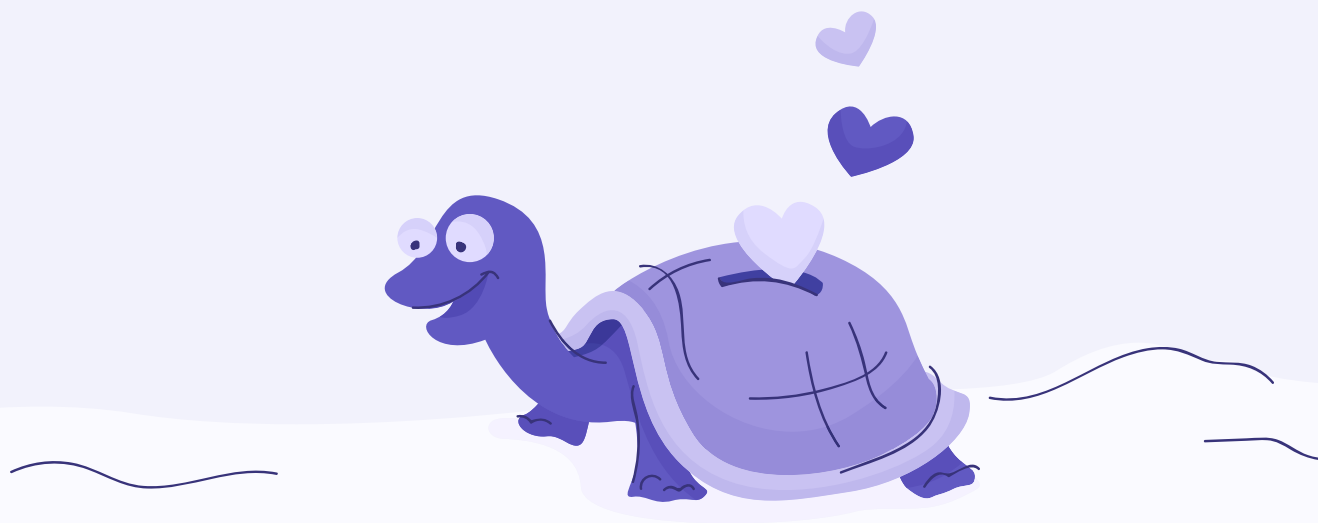
When creating your annual report, consider including a section focused on recurring donors and the impact they've made on your organization's accomplishments. Tease the report in an email to your recurring donors with a few high-level bullet points around the results you've seen. Then, attach the recurring giving section to your email and frame it as a "sneak peek" offer for them.





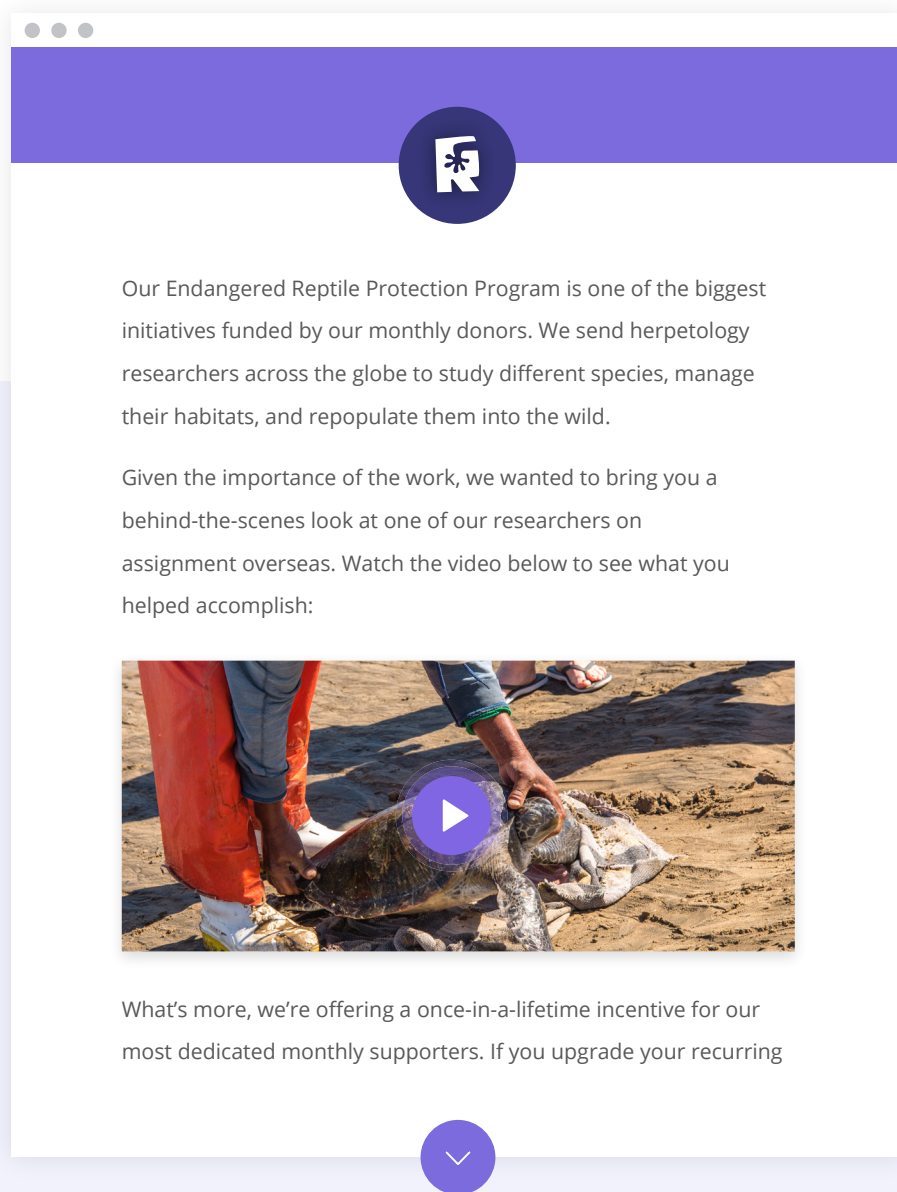
Keep your eyes open for the full report tomorrow, which will go into even more depth around the impact your gift has made. Thank you for your incredible generosity!

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7 | Behind-the-Scenes Showcase

Donors are likely unaware of many details or smaller projects that happen at your organization, either in the office or on the ground. Showcase some of these activities, especially to recurring donors. These can serve as tangible outcomes made possible by their gift, and can go a long way in encouraging them to upgrade their monthly donation.



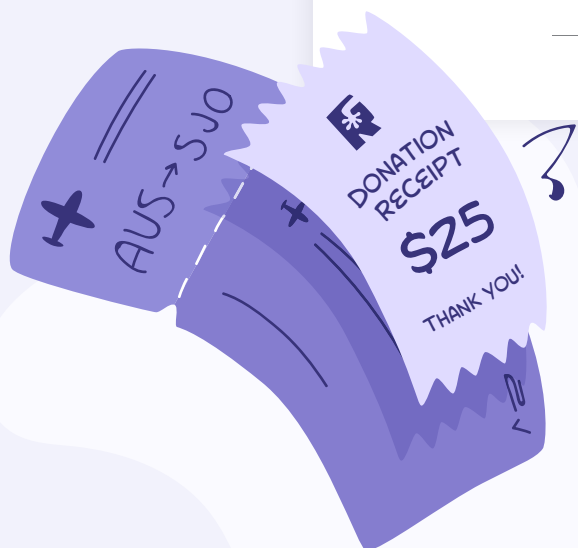


donation to \$200 per month or higher, we'll reserve a spot for you to attend next year's trip with our team.

Save Me a Spot

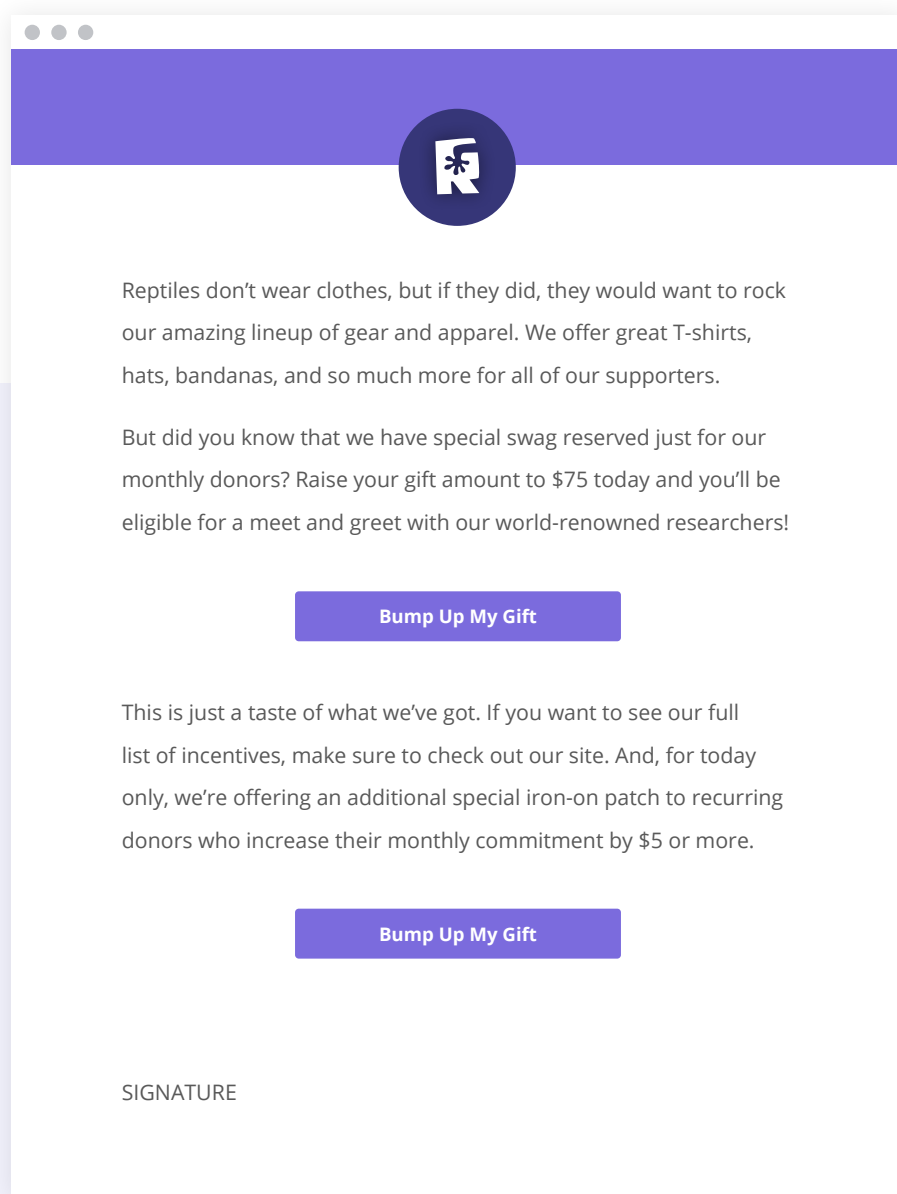
Donate today and get ready to hang out with some awesome reptiles, and even cooler researchers!

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8 | Ask for Commitment

Offering exclusive incentives for your recurring donors can help them feel like a special cohort of your community and encourage them to upgrade their gift. Highlight the various perks available for different tiers of monthly donors. You might even want to segment your emails based on gift size, so you can highlight the specific perk associated with the next donation level for the recipient.



Conclusion

Tweak these examples to suit your nonprofit's distinct style, brand, voice, and tone. Remember that these emails are more than just asks; they're opportunities to thank your donors and recognize their commitment to your organization. When you show donors that you appreciate them, they're more likely to continue—and even increase—their support. Lastly, don't be afraid to ask recurring donors to also give to your annual campaigns, such as Giving Tuesday or year-end.





Classy

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recurring giving program grow.

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